UPSC Current Affairs

Wednesday, 11 November 2026 · Sources: PIB and The Hindu · 23 items

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GS2	17	COP31: Can negotiators finally deliver results? | The Hindu ; Poland arrests two Ukrainians over alleged Russian espionage
GS3	2	How do tokamaks work to make nuclear fusion possible?; Industry seeks LTCG, STT cuts in Budget 2027; MSME relief al

Every item links to its original source: tap a headline or the Source line to open the full article on thehindu.com or the press release on pib.gov.in. The Hindu text here is only the short RSS excerpt.

GS Paper I: Heritage, Culture, History, Geography & Society

GEOGRAPHY

NMDC said to be in talks with Russia's Rosatom over lithium investments

MEDIUM IMPORTANCE · Both · Geography, International Relations, Economy

• Rosatom and Russian miner Nornickel, however, are developing the country's largest lithium deposit through their PolarLithium joint venture, with commercial production expected to begin by 2030

Why it matters for India and UPSC

• **International relations:** India's strategic autonomy: abstentions at the UN, call for dialogue and diplomacy, while keeping ties with Russia and the West.
• **Economy:** Discounted Russian crude, fertiliser and defence spares; Western sanctions and secondary tariffs create payment and trade risks for India.
• **Internal security:** Dependence on Russian defence equipment (S-400, Su-30) and the push for indigenisation (Atmanirbhar Bharat in defence).

Prelims pointers

• Key terms: NMDC, Russia, Rosatom, Rosatom and Russian, Nornickel

Static connect: Critical minerals

• The Centre has notified a list of critical minerals and launched the National Critical Mineral Mission (2025).
• KABIL (Khanij Bidesh India Ltd) secures overseas mineral assets.

UPSC angle: Energy transition, supply chains and mineral security (GS1, GS3).

Source: The Hindu, International, 10 Nov 2026 ·
https://www.thehindu.com/business/nmdc-said-to-be-in-talks-with-russias-rosatom-over-lithi

Cyclone-hit villages in Prakasam district remain without electricity

MEDIUM IMPORTANCE · Both · Geography, Science & Technology, Disaster Management

• The villagers are going to the nearest urban centre to charge their mobile phones at a cost of ■10 per charge and are facing difficulties in meeting their daily needs, including access to drinking water and arranging fuel for generators, sources say

Why it matters for India and UPSC

• **Geography & disasters:** India is exposed to cyclones, floods and heatwaves; the Disaster Management Act, 2005 (amended 2025), NDMA and NDRF/SDRF lead the response.
• **Governance & polity:** Shift from relief to risk reduction (Sendai Framework); early warning, CDRI and climate-resilient infrastructure.

Prelims pointers

• Key terms: Cyclone-hit, Prakasam

Source: The Hindu, National, 10 Nov 2026 · https://www.thehindu.com/news/national/andhra-pradesh/cyclone-hit-villages-in-prakasam-dis

HISTORY & ART AND CULTURE

Does the Temple wearable reveal useful information about brain health?

MEDIUM IMPORTANCE · Both · History & Art and Culture, Polity & Constitution, Governance & Social Justice

• Billionaire Deepinder Goyal has begun selling Temple, a temple-attached wearable he says can monitor brain health and ageing by measuring cerebral blood flow outside the lab.
• Critics and doctors question the device's medical claims, noting the evidence is preliminary, not peer-reviewed, and its core metric—the Brain Flow index—remains controversial amid concerns over links to longevity or cognitive outcomes

Prelims pointers

• Key terms: Does the Temple, Billionaire Deepinder Goyal, Temple, Critics, Brain Flow

Source: The Hindu, Health, 10 Nov 2026 · https://www.thehindu.com/sci-tech/health/does-the-temple-wearable-reveal-useful-informatio

INDIAN SOCIETY

Caste and class: On OBC reservation

MEDIUM IMPORTANCE · Mains · Indian Society

• Exclusion of creamy layer is essential, but must be done consistently

Why it matters for India and UPSC

• **Society:** Data and policy for social justice: the next Census will include caste enumeration; sub-classification of SC/ST (Supreme Court 2024) and the 50% ceiling (Indra Sawhney).
• **Governance & polity:** Targeting welfare and reservation policy needs reliable data; also linked to delimitation.

Prelims pointers

• Key terms: Caste, OBC, Exclusion

Source: The Hindu, Editorial, 10 Nov 2026 · https://www.thehindu.com/opinion/editorial/caste-and-class-on-obc-reservation/article71686

GS Paper II: Polity, Governance, Social Justice & IR

ENVIRONMENT & ECOLOGY

Supreme Court goes beyond Deepavali AQI, flags vehicular emissions polluting Delhi air

MEDIUM IMPORTANCE · Both · Environment & Ecology, Polity & Constitution, Governance & Social Justice

• The court says Delhi and the NCR bear the 'cumulative burden of vehicular traffic' and seeks to know what has been done to regulate in the capital the entry and plying of vehicles from neighbouring States

Why it matters for India and UPSC

• **Governance & polity:** Judicial review and the separation of powers; such rulings often clarify fundamental rights or federal relations and become Mains examples.
• **Society:** Access to justice and pendency (over 5 crore cases) affect citizens' trust in institutions.
• **Environment:** India's NDCs (45% cut in emission intensity of GDP from 2005 levels by 2030, 50% non-fossil power capacity, net zero by 2070) and the principle of CBDR-RC.
• **International relations:** India speaks for the Global South on climate finance and technology transfer; carbon border taxes like the EU's CBAM affect Indian exports.

Prelims pointers

• Key terms: Supreme Court, Deepavali AQI, Delhi, NCR

Static connect: Air quality governance

• Commission for Air Quality Management in NCR (statutory since 2021) enforces the Graded Response Action Plan (GRAP).
• National Clean Air Programme (NCAP, 2019) targets particulate reduction in non-attainment cities.
UPSC angle: Pollution control framework (GS3).

Source: The Hindu, Environment, 10 Nov 2026 ·
https://www.thehindu.com/news/national/supreme-court-goes-beyond-deepavali-aqi-flags-vehic

Delhi's air quality improves to 'poor' due to increased wind speed

MEDIUM IMPORTANCE · Both · Environment & Ecology, Governance & Social Justice

• On Monday, the day after Diwali, the capital's average Air Quality Index (AQI) stood at 376, in the 'very poor' category.

Why it matters for India and UPSC

• **Environment:** Air pollution is a public-health emergency in North India; NCAP, GRAP and the Commission for Air Quality Management (2021) are the policy tools.
• **Governance & polity:** Needs inter-state coordination (Punjab, Haryana, Delhi) and alternatives to stubble burning such as Happy Seeder and bio-decomposers.

Prelims pointers

• Key terms: Delhi, Monday, Diwali, Air Quality Index, AQI

Static connect: Air quality governance

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UPSC angle: Pollution control framework (GS3).

Source: The Hindu, Health, 10 Nov 2026 · https://www.thehindu.com/news/cities/Delhi/delhis-air-quality-improves-to-poor-due-to-incr

EU climate chief Wopke Hoekstra warns 'expectations low' from COP31 summit

MEDIUM IMPORTANCE · Both · Environment & Ecology, International Relations

• "If indeed we manage to make electrification the sole focus, or close to the sole focus of the COP, I think we have a chance to deliver on something that is truly meaningful," Wopke Hoekstra said

Why it matters for India and UPSC

• **Environment:** India's NDCs (45% cut in emission intensity of GDP from 2005 levels by 2030, 50% non-fossil power capacity, net zero by 2070) and the principle of CBDR-RC.
• **International relations:** India speaks for the Global South on climate finance and technology transfer; carbon border taxes like the EU's CBAM affect Indian exports.

Prelims pointers

• Key terms: Wopke Hoekstra, COP31, COP

Static connect: UNFCCC & Paris Agreement

• UNFCCC adopted at the 1992 Rio Earth Summit; the Conference of Parties (COP) meets yearly.
• Paris Agreement (COP21, 2015): keep warming well below 2°C, pursue 1.5°C; countries submit NDCs.
• India's targets include net zero by 2070.
UPSC angle: Climate negotiations and India's commitments (GS3).

Source: The Hindu, International, 10 Nov 2026 ·
https://www.thehindu.com/news/international/eu-climate-chief-wopke-hoekstra-warns-expectat

GOVERNANCE & SOCIAL JUSTICE

COP31: Can negotiators finally deliver results? | The Hindu explains

HIGH IMPORTANCE · Both · Governance & Social Justice, Environment & Ecology, Disaster Management

• From catastrophic floods in Nepal to record-breaking heat, droughts and wildfires, the climate crisis is no longer a future threat.
• As world leaders gather in Antalya for COP31, the focus has shifted from promises to implementation.

Why it matters for India and UPSC

• **Environment:** India's NDCs (45% cut in emission intensity of GDP from 2005 levels by 2030, 50% non-fossil power capacity, net zero by 2070) and the principle of CBDR-RC.
• **International relations:** India speaks for the Global South on climate finance and technology transfer; carbon border taxes like the EU's CBAM affect Indian exports.
• **Internal security:** Open border can be misused for trafficking, fake currency and movement of criminals; SSB guards it.
• **Economy:** Hydropower trade (India buys Nepali power), cross-border rail and petroleum pipelines.

Prelims pointers

• Key terms: COP31, Can, Hindu, From, Nepal

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UPSC angle: Climate negotiations and India's commitments (GS3).

Source: The Hindu, Environment, 10 Nov 2026 ·
https://www.thehindu.com/videos/cop31-can-negotiators-finally-deliver-results-the-hindu-ex

Transparency is essential to institutional credibility

MEDIUM IMPORTANCE · Both · Governance & Social Justice, Polity & Constitution

• Minority institutions opposing the FCRA amendments must demonstrate transparency and accountability themselves

Prelims pointers

• Key terms: Transparency, Minority, FCRA

Source: The Hindu, Lead (Op-Ed), 10 Nov 2026 · https://www.thehindu.com/opinion/lead/transparency-is-essential-to-institutional-credibili

APSCHE to launch digital platform to offer quality online education to students, faculty

MEDIUM IMPORTANCE · Both · Governance & Social Justice, Science & Technology

• The initiative named APSCHE LMS–MOOCs will enable students to register, explore courses, enrol in relevant Massive Open Online Courses (MOOCs), access digital learning materials, participate in assessments and monitor their academic progress

Prelims pointers

• Key terms: APSCHE, APSCHE LMS, MOOCs, Massive Open Online Courses

Source: The Hindu, National, 10 Nov 2026 · https://www.thehindu.com/news/national/andhra-pradesh/apsche-to-launch-digital-platform-to

Keralam Minister calls upon students to join fight against drug abuse

MEDIUM IMPORTANCE · Both · Governance & Social Justice, Science & Technology, Ethics & Integrity

• Keralam General Education Minister N.
• Samsudheen warns that the menace threatens not only individual lives but also the growth of society and its cultural values

Prelims pointers

• Key terms: Keralam Minister, Keralam General Education Minister, Samsudheen

Source: The Hindu, National, 10 Nov 2026 · https://www.thehindu.com/news/national/kerala/keralam-minister-calls-on-students-to-join-f

INTERNAL SECURITY

Israeli forces shoot dead 14-year-old in West Bank: Palestinian officials

MEDIUM IMPORTANCE · Both · Internal Security, International Relations, Economy

• The Israeli military, asked by AFP about the incident, said on Tuesday (November 10, 2026) it had acted to "thwart stone-hurling and terrorist attacks" in the area.

Why it matters for India and UPSC

• **Economy:** India imports most of its crude oil, much of it from the Gulf; conflict raises oil prices, shipping and insurance costs, inflation and the current account deficit.
• **Society:** About 9 million Indians live in the Gulf; their safety (evacuation operations such as Ajay/Kaveri) and remittances (India is the world's largest recipient) are at stake.
• **International relations:** India balances ties with Israel, Iran and the Arab states; projects like Chabahar and IMEC depend on regional stability.
• **Internal security:** Shows the threat from cross-border and home-grown terror modules, online radicalisation and terror financing; NIA and the UAPA, 1967 are the main legal and investigative tools.

Prelims pointers

• Key terms: Israeli, West Bank, Palestinian, AFP, Tuesday

Source: The Hindu, International, 10 Nov 2026 ·
https://www.thehindu.com/news/international/israeli-forces-shoot-dead-14-year-old-in-west-

INTERNATIONAL RELATIONS

Poland arrests two Ukrainians over alleged Russian espionage, sabotage

HIGH IMPORTANCE · Both · International Relations

• Poland has long ■accused Russia and its ally Belarus of waging a hybrid campaign involving sabotage, cyberattacks ■and disinformation since Moscow’s 2022 invasion of Ukraine

Why it matters for India and UPSC

• **International relations:** India's strategic autonomy: abstentions at the UN, call for dialogue and diplomacy, while keeping ties with Russia and the West.
• **Economy:** Discounted Russian crude, fertiliser and defence spares; Western sanctions and secondary tariffs create payment and trade risks for India.
• **Internal security:** Dependence on Russian defence equipment (S-400, Su-30) and the push for indigenisation (Atmanirbhar Bharat in defence).
• **Governance & polity:** IT Act 2000, Digital Personal Data Protection Act 2023, and the need for cyber hygiene and capacity in state police.

Prelims pointers

• Key terms: Poland, Ukrainians, Russian, Russia, Belarus

Source: The Hindu, International, 10 Nov 2026 ·
https://www.thehindu.com/news/international/poland-arrests-two-ukrainians-over-alleged-rus

Iran rejects France’s ‘baseless accusations’ on cyberattack

MEDIUM IMPORTANCE · Both · International Relations, Science & Technology

• Hundreds of French supermarkets were hit in the October 11 and 12 cyberattacks, which raised the temperatures in their refrigerators and freezers, forcing many to throw away entire inventories of perishable food

Why it matters for India and UPSC

• **Economy:** India imports most of its crude oil, much of it from the Gulf; conflict raises oil prices, shipping and insurance costs, inflation and the current account deficit.
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• **Internal security:** Cyber attacks on critical infrastructure and fraud like 'digital arrest' scams; CERT-In, NCIIPC and I4C are the response agencies.

Prelims pointers

• Key terms: Iran, France, Hundreds of French, October

Source: The Hindu, International, 10 Nov 2026 ·
https://www.thehindu.com/news/international/iran-rejects-frances-baseless-accusations-on-c

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POLITY & CONSTITUTION

New Israeli parliament to take aim at Netanyahu as Eisenkot seeks government

MEDIUM IMPORTANCE · Both · Polity & Constitution, International Relations

• President Isaac Herzog, ceremonially opening the session, called on all sides to work together and avoid a fresh election in a deeply polarised country weary from three years of war.

Why it matters for India and UPSC

• **Economy:** India imports most of its crude oil, much of it from the Gulf; conflict raises oil prices, shipping and insurance costs, inflation and the current account deficit.
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Prelims pointers

• Key terms: New Israeli, Netanyahu, Eisenkot, President Isaac Herzog

Source: The Hindu, International, 10 Nov 2026 ·
https://www.thehindu.com/news/international/new-israeli-parliament-to-take-aim-at-netanyah

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Malaysian court clears final hurdle for former PM Najib Razak's transfer to house arrest

MEDIUM IMPORTANCE · Both · Polity & Constitution, Economy

• Najib has been behind bars since August 2022, when the Kuala Lumpur High Court upheld his graft conviction linked to a multibillion-dollar looting of the state investment fund 1MDB.

Why it matters for India and UPSC

• **Governance & polity:** Judicial review and the separation of powers; such rulings often clarify fundamental rights or federal relations and become Mains examples.
• **Society:** Access to justice and pendency (over 5 crore cases) affect citizens' trust in institutions.

Prelims pointers

• Key terms: Malaysian, PM Najib Razak, Najib, August, Kuala Lumpur High Court

Source: The Hindu, International, 10 Nov 2026 ·
https://www.thehindu.com/news/international/malaysian-court-clears-final-hurdle-for-former

Pranab Mukherjee hinted at desire to become PM, ‘shocked’ me, writes Sonia Gandhi

MEDIUM IMPORTANCE · Both · Polity & Constitution

• In her memoir, former Congress president recalls 2010 conversation; Pranab Mukherjee’s daughter Sharmistha asks what there was to be shocked about, says it is not a crime to be ambitious

Prelims pointers

• Key terms: Pranab Mukherjee, Sonia Gandhi, Congress, Sharmistha

Source: The Hindu, National, 10 Nov 2026 ·
https://www.thehindu.com/news/national/pranab-mukherjee-hinted-at-desire-to-become-pm-shoc

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ALSO IN THE NEWS (LOWER PRIORITY)

• Andhra Pradesh weighs making father’s name optional in official documents (The Hindu, National, 10 Nov 2026)
• After Bangladesh rules out passport for Hasina, India says ‘travel document’ needed (The Hindu, National, 10 Nov 2026)
• Housing assistance instalments for 32,000 families this fiscal: Minister (The Hindu, National, 10 Nov 2026)
• Air pollution goes through the roof in parts of Delhi on Deepavali night (The Hindu, Health, 09 Nov 2026)

GS Paper III: Economy, Environment, S&T, Security & DM

ECONOMY

Industry seeks LTCG, STT cuts in Budget 2027; MSME relief also on wish list

MEDIUM IMPORTANCE · Both · Economy

• Several industry bodies have been meeting top officials of the Finance Ministry as part of the annual pre-Budget consultation process

Why it matters for India and UPSC

• **Economy:** Shows the health of the economy and fiscal space for capex and welfare; FRBM targets and centre–state revenue sharing (Finance Commission, GST Council).
• **Governance & polity:** Cooperative fiscal federalism: GST Council (Article 279A) and states' demands for a larger share of the divisible pool.

Prelims pointers

• Key terms: Industry, LTCG, STT, Budget, MSME

Source: The Hindu, Economy, 10 Nov 2026 ·
https://www.thehindu.com/business/Economy/industry-seeks-ltcg-stt-cuts-in-budget-2027-msme

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SCIENCE & TECHNOLOGY

How do tokamaks work to make nuclear fusion possible?

MEDIUM IMPORTANCE · Both · Science & Technology

• A tokamak uses magnetic fields to confine superhot plasma to enable nuclear fusion; despite advances in research, engineering challenges remain, and no tokamak has generated net energy for commercial power

Prelims pointers

• Key terms: How

Source: The Hindu, Science, 10 Nov 2026 ·
https://www.thehindu.com/sci-tech/science/how-do-tokamaks-work-to-make-nuclear-fusion-poss

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